

PRINTABLE · NO MESS · 5 MINUTES

Easy Christmas Elf Ideas

30 quick, no-mess setups with things you already have, plus a December planner and cut-out elf-size signs.

30 ideas · Planner · Props · US Letter + A4

START HERE

How to use your idea cards

No more 11 p.m. panic scrolling. Pick your ideas in advance, write them on the December planner, and keep the cards next to your bed. Every setup takes about five minutes and uses things you already have.

1. **Plan in one sitting**
   Choose 24 ideas and write the numbers on the December planner. Save the easiest ones for busy school nights.
2. **Cut out the props**
   The elf-size signs make any setup look finished. Print them on card stock and fold them into little tents.
3. **Set a reminder**
   A 9 p.m. phone alarm is the best elf helper ever invented.
4. **Keep it kind**
   Pair a setup with a small kindness mission. The kids will remember how it felt, not how fancy it was.

Safety first

Keep scissors, small candies and string out of reach of little children. Adult setup only.

Good to know

"Christmas Elf" is a generic name for this activity. Not affiliated with any elf doll brand: use any toy you have.

DECEMBER PLANNER

My 24-day elf plan

1 Idea # ------	**2** Idea # ------	**3** Idea # ------	**4** Idea # ------
5 Idea # ------	**6** Idea # ------	**7** Idea # ------	**8** Idea # ------
9 Idea # ------	**10** Idea # ------	**11** Idea # ------	**12** Idea # ------
13 Idea # ------	**14** Idea # ------	**15** Idea # ------	**16** Idea # ------
17 Idea # ------	**18** Idea # ------	**19** Idea # ------	**20** Idea # ------
21 Idea # ------	**22** Idea # ------	**23** Idea # ------	**24** Idea # ------

CUT ALONG THE DASHED LINES

Ideas 1-6

1 Marshmallow Bath

The elf relaxes in a mug or bowl full of mini marshmallows, with a tiny towel on its head.

You need: Mug, mini marshmallows, napkin

2 Toilet Paper Snowman

Stack three rolls, add a scarf and a paper face. The elf proudly stands next to its snowman.

You need: 3 TP rolls, scarf, paper

3 Zip-Line Ride

Tie a string between two chairs and hang the elf from it with a clothespin.

You need: String, clothespin

4 Fishing for Goldfish

The elf sits on the sink edge with a pencil fishing rod over a bowl of fish crackers.

You need: Pencil, string, crackers

5 Reading Corner

The elf reads a picture book to a circle of stuffed animals.

You need: Book, stuffed toys

6 Hide and Seek Note

The elf hides with a note: 'Count to 20 and come find me!'

You need: Note from the props page

CUT ALONG THE DASHED LINES

Ideas 7-12

7 Elf-Sized Breakfast

A tiny pancake or cereal bowl waits on the table with a 'Good morning!' note.

You need: Cereal, small bowl

8 Paper Snowflake Party

Paper snowflakes all over the table, and the elf holds the scissors (handles only).

You need: Paper, child-safe scissors

9 Stuck in the Garland

The elf is tangled in the Christmas garland, waving for help.

You need: Garland or tinsel

10 Lego Builder

The elf built a tiny house out of blocks, with a 'Do Not Disturb: Elf at Work' sign.

You need: Building blocks, sign

11 Kindness Mission

The elf holds a card with today's kind mission: 'Make a card for Grandma'.

You need: Note card

12 Hot Cocoa Bar

Three mugs and a packet of cocoa, ready for an after-school treat.

You need: Cocoa packets, mugs

CUT ALONG THE DASHED LINES

Ideas 13-18

13 Selfie Elf

The elf poses with your phone (camera app open) as if it took a selfie overnight.

You need: Phone, 1 photo

14 Sock Snowball Fight

Rolled-up white socks everywhere, the elf hiding behind a pillow fort.

You need: White socks, pillow

15 Candy Cane Fishing

Candy canes hooked over the edge of a bowl, the elf holding one like a fishing pole.

You need: Candy canes, bowl

16 Doctor Elf

The elf has a bandage on its arm and gives a 'checkup' to stuffed animals.

You need: Bandage, stuffed toys

17 Paper Chain Countdown

A new paper chain with one link for each day left until Christmas.

You need: Paper strips, tape

18 Elf Crossing

Toy cars stop at a crosswalk made of paper strips while the elf crosses.

You need: Toy cars, white paper

CUT ALONG THE DASHED LINES

Ideas 19-24

19 Fridge Visit

The elf sits inside the fridge door with a note: 'It's cold, just like home!'

You need: Nothing extra

20 Tic-Tac-Toe

The elf starts a game of tic-tac-toe with a cereal-piece board and waits for your move.

You need: Paper, cereal

21 Wrapping Paper Jail

The elf is 'wrapped' on a chair: 'I tried to wrap myself as a present!'

You need: Wrapping paper, tape

22 Movie Night

The elf and some toys sit in front of the TV with a tiny bowl of popcorn.

You need: Popcorn, small bowl

23 Treasure Map

A hand-drawn map leads to a small treat hidden in the house.

You need: Paper, small treat

24 Elf Workout

The elf exercises with tiny 'weights' made of marshmallows and toothpicks.

You need: Marshmallows, toothpicks

CUT ALONG THE DASHED LINES

Ideas 25-30

25 Art Gallery

The elf 'drew' portraits of each family member and hung them on the fridge.

You need: Paper, crayons

26 Tooth Brushing Buddy

The elf waits next to the toothbrushes with a note: 'Two minutes, I'm timing!'

You need: Note card

27 Thank-You Cards

The elf sets out blank cards and crayons: 'Who will you thank today?'

You need: Cards, crayons

28 Elf Sleepover

The elf sleeps in a tiny bed made of a tissue box, next to a favorite toy.

You need: Tissue box, washcloth

29 Santa Video Call

The elf sits by a laptop or tablet showing a picture of the North Pole.

You need: Laptop or tablet

30 Goodbye Hug

On the last day, the elf hugs each family member's toothbrush with a goodbye note.

You need: Goodbye note

CUT, FOLD, DONE

Elf-size signs

Do Not Disturb

Elf at work

Elf Crossing

Slow down, please

Snowball Fight Zone

Enter at your own risk

Out of Office

Back tonight · North Pole

Count to 20

and come find me!

Kindness Mission

Today: _____

FOR GROWN-UPS

Elf emergency list

Forgot again? These three take under one minute.

1. The fridge visit

Pop the elf inside the fridge door. Done.

2. Count to 20

Hide the elf anywhere and leave the "Count to 20" sign on the table.

3. The kindness card

Leave the elf where it was with a "Kindness Mission" sign. Kids love a mission more than a move.

OUR ELF'S NAME

ARRIVAL DATE

GOODBYE DATE

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